MONTHLY UPDATE

Madagascar: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

On 4 September the deputies deferred the cybercrime recast and the electronic communications bill to a later session, and neither is on the order paper of the session that opened on 17 September. A second phase of biometric enrolment opened on 16 September, aiming at more than 10 million adults by July 2027, and the beneficial-owner register moved into operation on 18 September with four data-sharing protocols.

In payments, the finance ministry announced a task force on mobile-money complaints on 15 September, and BGFIBank presented a mobile-banking app open to people without a bank account.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Madagascar scores 9 of 16 points against the Open Government Partnership's 12-point eligibility threshold as it seeks to rejoin the body it first joined in December 2016.

Legislation and regulation

The extraordinary session ended without passing a digital law. The National Assembly deferred five bills to a later session on 4 September, the recast cybercrime law and the electronic communications and digital infrastructure bill first among them, the deputies saying they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms and the Assembly's president saying he did not care to imagine what would have followed had they not deferred. The cybercrime bill would create a digital protection and investigation unit and, under article 75, give it permanent round-the-clock technical access to operators' systems; commentary reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests. A third bill, authorising ratification of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, went to parliament on 28 August with the cybercrime recast and was deferred with it. The session that opened on 17 September lists seventeen bills and neither digital bill among them, its order paper set by presidential decree; no bill text is published. The electronic communications bill, submitted to the Assembly on 28 August, waits for a future session; its text, 140 articles, would end every monopoly in the sector with no transitional period and oblige data-centre operators to keep data on national territory.

Regional collaboration

On 10 September Madagascar was one of 49 states, with the European Space Agency, to sign an international declaration on space-based scientific data, committing to open access to satellite observation data save justified exceptions, open licences and harmonised exchange standards. It names no implementing measure.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The satellite route to isolated areas moved from announcement to hardware: the digital ministry received 300 satellite kits with free internet service under a partnership with the operator, after free connectivity at the main public universities. No site list is published.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity programme opened its second phase on National Identity Day. The interior minister launched mass biometric registration at Anosy on 16 September, assigning each person a unique identification number, with the World Bank financing the operation through the DECIM project, targeting more than 10 million citizens over 18 by July 2027, with 1,000 kits added after a three-month pause to evaluate the first phase. The day itself, institutionalised by decree 2024-067, opened on 15 September with a conference of more than 150 people preparing the 2027-2036 civil-registration decade. No enrolment count for the second phase has been published.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 15 September the finance ministry announced a task force with the banking supervisor and the telecoms regulator on lost money, failed transactions and slow complaint handling, with no start date given. The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a digital finance programme on 2 September targeting 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal through the Mixx and MVola platforms, under a US$160 million senior corporate loan approved to the group in January 2025 with a US$2.5 million grant for financial literacy and credit access and more than US$10 million allocated for 22,000 women entrepreneurs in Madagascar through MVola. The grant is not a lending pool, and no enrolment or disbursement figure is published for the programme itself.

BGFIBank Madagasikara presented its Gasy Money mobile-banking app on Friday 18 September, open to non-customers on any network, including people without a bank account, with transfers to other app accounts, bank accounts and Airtel Money. No user or transaction figure is published. The largest mobile money operator made merchant payments free for customers, the fee borne by the merchant, and reported close to 4 million users, more than 60,000 cashpoints and more than 50,000 accepting merchants. The capital's urban commune launched the digitalisation of its markets, registering traders and replacing paper tickets with merchant cards debited by payment terminals.

Registries

The social registry reached about 2.7 million households, nearly 12 million people, with eight districts added to the 20 already surveyed.

On National Identity Day a second phase of the Izaho Tokana 2.0 registration drive opened, answering a 2025 survey finding that close to 20 per cent of children under five hold no birth certificate. The same week the first 124 cooperatives received biometric cards under a national cooperative census.

The beneficial-owner register moved into operation on 18 September, when the tax directorate signed four protocols to cross-match it with the trade and companies register, the anti-corruption bureau, the economic development board and the chamber of notaries.

Sectoral management information systems

On 18 September a Japan-funded International Organization for Migration project closed after two years, having deployed mobile kits of the MIDAS migration-data system at the port of Mahajanga that transmit directly to the national headquarters. No count of entry points covered is given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 21 September the commerce ministry began training its regional directorates at Mahamasina on Alalana, a platform for export-authorisation requests covering products including vanilla and clove; no launch date, cost or vendor was given. The tax directorate launched the Torohy platform on 9 October 2026 for the public to report corruption and related offences in the tax administration; the head of state asked for the same mechanism at customs and the treasury.

The digital ministry said its e-Pasipaoro online passport application portal is in testing, for first applications, renewals and replacements with online filing, payment and tracking, while biometric capture and signature stay in person. No go-live date is stated.

Technology

ICT Industry

The government outsourcing-skills programme certified 99 of the 111 trainees in its second seven-week cohort on 24 September, delivered with a private academy under a World Bank-supported project. No placement figure is published, so what the cohort shows is completion rather than jobs.

Capacity

Literacy

The vocational training ministry signed a partnership with France's Pix public-interest group on 11 September to develop and certify young people's digital skills, including exam centres, trainer training and a study of putting Pix into vocational curricula. No candidate target, cost or start date is given.

Inclusion

Access to services

A postal microfinance institution launched 12-month laptop credit for 1,400 master's students in September, funded from the connectivity project.

Digital divides

The telecoms regulator posted the 2025 financial statements of the telecoms and ICT development fund, the universal-service fund it manages, alongside those for 2024. They follow a Cour des comptes audit that asked for all the fund's disbursements to be suspended; whether an auditor's opinion accompanies the statements is not established.

Data

Open data

The economy and finance ministry plans wider publication of budget information after an international assessment scored the country below its threshold, and the Cour des comptes will resume publishing the budget settlement document in 2027.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MDG/MDG-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0